Sample tracking: what we need

Wexcombe Seed Testing Laboratory
Notes for the systems review

1. Why we are looking at this

We cannot see where a sample is without going to the bench or ringing.
Every result is written three times: bench sheet, results database, certificate.
A priority agreed with a submitter is not visible to the bench once it is allocated.
Turnaround is not measured while a sample is in progress.
A late certificate is found when the submitter rings.
Reception, the benches and the Laboratory Manager each keep a list, and they disagree.

2. What we want

W-1 One register that reception, the benches and the Laboratory Manager all work from.
W-2 The status of every sample visible at each stage, from receipt to certificate, without asking anyone.
W-3 Priority requests approved by the Laboratory Manager on screen, not on the form, and visible to every bench the same day.
W-4 Results entered once. The results database stays the system of record for results.
W-5 The certificate prepared from recorded results without re-typing, ready to sign.
W-6 Turnaround measured for every sample against the targets in QP-07 section 6.5, with a sample shown before it is late rather than after.
W-7 Re-test requests raised and authorised on screen, with the authorisation number carried to the bench sheet.
W-8 A daily list for each bench of the samples allocated to it, in priority order.
W-9 A monthly summary of samples received, certified and late, by submitter and test.
W-10 The whole picture for the Laboratory Director without asking anyone for a report.

3. Constraints

The results database cannot be replaced or altered.
It is validated for the accreditation, and results must continue to be held there.
Certificates must be signed by an authorised signatory as QP-07 section 6.4 requires.
Nothing may issue a certificate without a signature.
Bench analysts must not enter a result twice.
Analysts must not need a keyboard at the bench while they are handling seed.
Bench sheets, test requests and certificates must still be retained for six years.
Submitters' names, samples and results are confidential to the submitter.

4. Out of scope

Invoicing and the accounts system.
The methods manual and the tests themselves.
The results database and its validation.
Seed health testing (QP-09).